

MIRROR PAGE

A dark comic adventure: find your friend among the vampires, and free the captured hero. • TGC Game Jam 2026 Proposal

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Themes (All 3)	COMIC TWIST LIGHT	Target Playtime	17 – 19 mins first playthrough (20 min hard cap)
Engine & Renderer	Godot 4.7, GDScript only, GL Compatibility Renderer (Web/HTML5 export hosted on itch.io)		

1. PITCH & CORE CONCEPT

The game opens with a cutscene: the Earth once lived in peace, guarded by **four superheroes**, until a **masked villain** covered it in darkness. A fixed **Narrator** then tells four comic stories in a row. Each is built for one comic hero (superhero, noir detective, manga ninja, pop-art space hero) in a **pitch-dark level of 8 rooms in a random layout** where only your torch is lit; you finish interactive tasks to fill a progress bar. **Level 1 is a calm warm-up**, and at its end the Narrator captures that hero. **From level 2**, two identical **vampires** lurk in the dark: your **friend** and the comic's **villain** (random), who starts **timed sabotage**. Catch one in your torchlight (Among Us style cutscene) and choose **REVEAL** or **KILL**: reveal a friend and he becomes an ally who no longer fears light; reveal the villain and you are teleported into a 30 to 60 second parkour chase; kill the villain and he is gone; kill a friend and he dies. After four levels the heroes of levels 2, 3 and 4 fight the **Narrator one on one**, each with his own special power, to free the captured hero. The first two are canonically defeated, but each cracks a layer of the Narrator's power; the level 4 hero finishes it: if he wins, sunlight makes the Narrator evaporate; if not, he throws the captured hero into lava. A closing cutscene mirrors the opening: the Earth in sunlight with its heroes, or still in darkness.

2. INTEGRATION OF THE THREE THEMES

Theme	How It Drives Gameplay & Narrative
Comic	A fixed Narrator frames four comic worlds, each with its own hero and look (ink outlines, halftone paper, caption boxes, onomatopoeia). The light puzzles are comic pages whose panels you drag around.
Light	Every level is dark: only the area around your torch is visible, so light is how you explore, how you catch vampires (they freeze when held in the beam) and how you solve the mirror puzzles and the final duels.
Twist	Friend or villain? Two identical vampires, chosen at random, so every Reveal or Kill is a gamble with four different outcomes. The Narrator is the final twist: he captured the first hero and is the real saboteur. He also tampers with the interface and the puzzle rules.

3. CORE MECHANICS

- **Explore the dark:** smooth 8-direction walking in a random 8-room layout that is new every level. Press M for the map.
- **28 interactive tasks over 4 levels, none repeated:** comic tasks (order panels, speech bubbles, sound effects, connect the dots, ink mixing), college tasks (debug code, logic gates, quiz, proofreading, safe cracking) and classics (wires, fuses, pipes, memory), plus 6 light-puzzle pages with rule twists (lying mirrors, light that bends at gutters, goal flip).
- **Villain-started sabotage:** from level 2 the villain vampire walks to a spot and starts a timer; a fix console must be completed in time or you lose hearts (big sabotage: 2 hearts). In level 4 he also undoes one finished task.
- **Vampires, Reveal or Kill:** hold the torch on a vampire for an Among Us style cutscene, then choose. Reveal the friend: an ally who ignores light and helps more each level. Reveal the villain: you are teleported into a 30 to 60 second parkour chase against the clock. Kill the villain: he is gone. Kill the friend: he dies and your ending suffers.
- **Adaptive difficulty and score:** going over par makes the next level a little easier; a score (tasks, sabotage stopped, hearts, deaths, choices, small time bonus) gives S/A/B/C ranks. Checkpoints at each level start; level and total timers.

4. LEVELS AND HEROES

#	Hero and world	Par	Tasks	Vampires, sabotage and friend help
1	Superhero pulp	2:00	4	Warm-up: no vampires, no sabotage. At the end the Narrator captures this hero.
2	Noir detective	3:00	6	Vampires appear. 1 sabotage. Revealed friend points to the nearest task.
3	Manga ninja	4:00	8	2 big sabotages. Friend also finishes small tasks and adds time.
4	Pop-art space hero	5:00	10	2 big sabotages and a task undone. Friend also fixes a sabotage and shields you once.

5. FINAL BOSS, CUTSCENES AND ENDINGS

- **Relay duels, special powers:** after level 4 the heroes of levels 2, 3 and 4 fight the Narrator one on one, in that order, at least 3 minutes in all. Each hero has his own special power: the noir detective's *Deduction* (slows time and shows the Narrator's next attack), the manga ninja's *Light Dash* (a fast dash that slices through ink), the space hero's *Prism Cannon* (splits and reflects a beam, and charges a Solar Flare). It is canon that the level 2 and level 3 heroes are defeated, but each one cracks a layer of the Narrator's dark shield. The level 4 hero faces the weakened Narrator, and what you did earlier (friends revealed or killed, how well the first duels went) decides how hard that last duel is.
- **Two endings:** if the level 4 hero wins, his Solar Flare floods the room with sunlight and the Narrator evaporates. If he loses, the Narrator throws the captured level 1 hero into lava.
- **Cutscenes:** an opening cutscene (the peaceful Earth guarded by four superheroes, then covered in darkness by a masked villain) and a mirrored closing cutscene (sunlight returns, or darkness stays, depending on the ending). In between, Among Us style scenes for detecting a vampire, revealing a friend, revealing the villain (ending in a teleport to the parkour), killing a friend or the villain (ejection into space), and the level 1 capture. All are skippable.

6. SCOPE BOUNDARIES

In Scope: 4 generated dark levels with torch lighting, 28 tasks (never repeated), villain sabotage, hearts and checkpoints, two vampires with the Reveal / Kill choice and friend ally, parkour chase, relay boss duels, cutscenes, score and ranks, narrator and four heroes, menus, sound and music, web export.

Out of Scope (Strictly Cut): level editor, save slots, mobile touch, gamepads, multiplayer, more than 4 levels or heroes, any existing comic character (all heroes and villains are original).

7. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & WEB FEASIBILITY

- **Godot 4.7, GDScript only, GL Compatibility renderer:** single-threaded Web export, no native extensions. 2D lights and darkness verified in a browser build.
- **Data-driven and testable:** a pure-logic puzzle model with headless unit tests and a brute-force solver that proves every puzzle solvable; levels are generated at run time (8 rooms, corridors, consoles) and a generator test checks that 100+ levels are fully reachable. Every task is its own class registered by name.
- **Status at proposal time:** the whole loop already runs: levels, tasks, sabotage, vampires, choice, parkour, cutscenes, score and checkpoints.

8. 100-HOUR DEVELOPMENT MILESTONES

Hours	Phase & Deliverables	Current Status
0 – 12	Concept lock, core engine and levels, tasks, sabotage, vampires, parkour, cutscenes, proposal.	COMPLETE
12 – 30	Narrator system, hero and theme for level 1, tutorial, level 1 capture cutscene, polish of the vampire choice.	NEXT
30 – 55	Heroes and themes for levels 2 and 3, friend ally and parkour polish, first outside playtests.	Planned
55 – 75	Level 4, the three relay duels, sunlight and lava endings, transitions, fourth-wall twists, shader, audio.	Planned
75 – 85	Balance, par times, playtests, bug fixing. Feature freeze at Hour 85.	Planned
85 – 100	Fixes only, web export, itch.io page, README and CREDITS audit, submission by Hour 96.	Planned

9. ASSETS & AI DISCLOSURE

- **Assets:** no paid assets. Fonts **Bangers** and **Comic Neue** (SIL OFL 1.1); sound effects and music generated procedurally (CC0); all art is drawn in code or generated procedurally. Every asset is listed in CREDITS.md. The open-source Godot AI plugin (MIT) is used in the editor only and is not part of the game.
- **AI tools:** Claude Code (architecture and gameplay code), Antigravity (UI, art and audio, browser tests) and ChatGPT/Codex (tests and documents), all logged in docs/AI_USAGE.md. Story, design decisions, characters and direction are the developer's own.

10. RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Identified Risk	Proactive Mitigation Strategy
Scope (four heroes, duels, cutscenes)	Everything shares one engine, one cutscene template and one duel engine; a written cut list and a feature freeze at Hour 85.
A pure-chance choice feels unfair	All four outcomes are fun, not punishing; early playtests at Hour 30; level 1 is a safe warm-up.
Combat or parkour is not fun	Simple readable mechanics, playtests at Hours 45 and 70, fallbacks (shorter parkour, duels without mirrors).
Web export or performance bugs	Browser test on every milestone, Compatibility renderer from day one, small asset budget.